

WOULD A CITY INSTALL A STATUE OF A FEATHERED FOWL ON WORLD CHICKEN RESPECT DAY?

KOLKATA | Chicken Run

The joke goes that the national bird of north India is butter chicken. People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals (PETA) are not amused and have taken up the cause of saving the chicken. In order to mark International Chicken Respect Day on May 4, PETA wrote a letter to the Municipal Corporation of Kolkata asking it to install a statue of a chicken on a busy junction to "convince people to keep chicken off their plates", according to PETA's chief functionary, Anuradha Sawhney.

by Swagata Sen

DELHI | Heat Stroke

Looks like the intense heat in Rajasthan has claimed yet another species of victim—of the striped kind. The Rajasthan state Government has stalled its plan to relocate a tiger from Ranthambore National Park to Sariska Tiger Reserve. "Tigers can suffer a sunstroke or die if we try to trap them for relocation," says Rajesh Gopal, member secretary, National Tiger Conservation Authority. The plan to relocate a male tiger to Sariska will now have to wait till the monsoon is over.

by Rahul Tewari

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM | Roman Plot

If archaeological findings are anything to go by, Pattanam in Ernakulam district may just be the oldest port site in the Indian Ocean rim with links to ancient Rome. The third phase of the three-year-old archaeological excavations conducted by the Kerala Council of Historical Research (KCHR) have unearthed a variety of tangible evidence. "We discovered semi-precious stones, copper coins, iron, copper, tin and gold artefacts, terracotta lamps, etc.," says P. J. Cherian, director, KCHR. Pattanam excavations have also unearthed evidence of the site's trade relations with West Asia even predating the Roman connections. **by M.G. Radhakrishnan**

Findings of the Pattanam excavation



ONCE A LANDMARK, ST. JOSEPH'S COLLEGE IS BEING DEMOLISHED FOR SAFETY REASONS

BANGALORE | FADING AWAY

With its Latin motto 'Fide et Labore' (faith and toil), the century-old St. Joseph's Arts and Science College stood as a legendary Bangalore landmark. But the Gothic-style granite structure that had sported the city's only astronomical observatory after the Indian Institute of Science was just not safe to be used further, says its management, the Society of Jesus. The colonial structure is being demolished and will be replaced by a three-floor concrete building with a 1,000-seat modern auditorium. The Jesuit fathers had tried to repair the old building but after experts termed it 'weak' and 'unusable', classes were shifted to a new block that was built a kilometre away on Langford Road. The heavy traffic on Bangalore's arterial Residency Road has only added to the building's wear and tear. **by Stephen David**

PARIKSHIT RAO



ST. JOSEPH'S ARTS AND SCIENCE COLLEGE IN RUINS